shows Lord Vishnu in an unusual meditative *padmasana* pose. Since photography is forbidden and the statue always draped in vestments and garlands, it is impossible to make out what actually lies underneath. According to the *Skanda Purana*, this *murti* is said to have been recovered by Adi Shankara himself from a nearby lake and enshrined by him in the temple he built for it.

9 P. B. Desai, 'No. 19 – More inscriptions at Aldar', *Epigraphia Indica* Vol. XXIX, pp. 140–4, 1951–2.

10 Quoted by S. Anand, 'Bodhi's Tamil afterglow', *Outlook* magazine, 19 July 2004.

11 N. Vasu, *The Modern Buddhism and its Followers in Orissa*, 1911, pp. 158–59.

12 Abhimanyu Dash, 'Invasions on the temple of Lord Jagannath, Puri', *Orissa Review*, July 2012.

13 Ibid.

14 George Turnour, 'Account of the tooth relic of Ceylon', *Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal*, Vol. VI, Part 2, 1837.

15 Its probable destruction at the hands of the Portuguese is told in Charles Allen, *The Buddha and the Sahibs*, 2002.

16 Alexander Cunningham, *The Bhilsa topes*, Ch. XXVII, 1853.

CHAPTER 8: CHOLAMANDALAM INTO COROMANDEL

1 *Itinerario de Ludouico de Varthema Bolognese nello Egypto, nella Surria, nella Arabia deserta & felice, nella Persia, nella India & Ethiopia*, 1510; R. A. Eden, *History of Travayle in the East and West Indies*, 1577.

2 Richard Burton, *Footsteps in East Africa*, 1856.

3 Marcus Vink, 'The World's oldest trade: Dutch slavery and slave trade in the Indian Ocean in the seventeenth century', *Journal of World History*, June 2003.